

01 Get it

02 Trust it

03 Use it

04 Stretch it

MCP 101 · STRETCH IT · DID YOU KNOW?

From good answers to *your own workflow*

The questions that work, the habits that keep answers right, and the shortcut most teams never try: turning a good answer into a skill.

Ask for the outcome. *Claude picks the tools.*

Backstory MCP has 17 tools working behind the scenes. You only need three kinds of questions to get the outcome you want.



One account or deal

01

IN YOUR AI TOOL · BACKSTORY MCP

ASK

“Catch me up on Halden Freight.”

YOU GET

A call-ready brief: recent activity, risks and who's involved.

Good to know: Covers the last 30 days. Use the full company name.

A list

02

IN YOUR AI TOOL · BACKSTORY MCP

ASK

“Which of my team's deals closing this quarter have engagement under 50?”

YOU GET

A short list of the deals that need you this week.

Good to know: Check that Backstory read it as *your* deals and the right window.

Backstory's assistant

03

START WITH “ASK BACKSTORY'S ASSISTANT”

ASK

“Ask Backstory's assistant what the big themes have been with Halden Freight over the last 90 days.”

YOU GET

The story of the relationship, ready for a QBR or a handoff.

Good to know: Name the period. It reaches about three months back reliably.



Backstory, your calendar and your email *in one prompt*

Each one covers a different piece. Connect all three in the same AI tool and one ask covers the week.



Backstory

WHAT'S AT RISK

Summaries of captured email, meeting and CRM activity from the last 30 days: risks, next steps and who's involved.

+

CONNECTOR



Calendar

WHAT'S ON THIS WEEK

The meetings ahead. Backstory can't see the calendar ahead on its own.

Tue 9:00	Halden Freight
11:30	Vantage Retail

+

CONNECTOR



Email

WHO'S WAITING ON A REPLY

The latest single thread. Backstory summarizes activity by week, not one email at a time.

Dana R.	Re: revised pricing
Jordan E.	Next steps

TRY

- 1 *"Check my calendar for this week."*
- 2 *"Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight."*

Repeat step 2 for each customer meeting.

YOUR AI TOOL · CLAUDE

MOCK DATA

Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight.

■ Used Calendar · Used Backstory >

TUE 9:00 **Halden Freight.** Pricing concerns raised twice. CFO not in a meeting in 26 days.

DO NEXT Bring revised pricing and ask Dana Ruiz to invite the CFO.



Seven habits for the *right answer, first time*

Grouped by when you use them: before you ask, as you read the answer, and when you go deeper.

BEFORE YOU ASK Set it up

01 Use the full company name

Short names can match the wrong account.
Check the name in the first answer.

02 One question per chat

Start a new chat when the question changes.
Long chats drift.

AS YOU READ Check the answer

03 Read how Backstory understood a list

Your deals, the right window, highest first.

04 Remember the 30-day window

One-account answers cover the last 30 days. Say so when you share.

05 A thin answer isn't "nothing happened"

The activity may not have been captured.

GOING DEEPER Reach further back

06 Start with "Ask Backstory's assistant"

For themes, history and anything older than 30 days.

07 Check the assistant's figures

Confirm amounts and dates against the deal record.

SHORTCUT

Build these habits into a skill once, and every answer follows them automatically.

[See slide 05 →](#)

THE BIGGEST SHORTCUT

When you land on an answer you like, *turn it into a skill.*

Then you get that result every time, and you keep improving it as you learn and as models change. That's what turns using the MCP into having your own Backstory workflow.

REACH FOR IT

Before customer calls

Writing follow-ups

Planning your week

Taking over an account

Skills instead of *go-to prompts*

A skill is a saved set of instructions that Claude picks up on its own when your ask matches. You stop pasting the same prompt and start getting the same result.

	 Go-to prompt	 Standing instructions	 Skill
WHAT IT IS	A prompt you saved somewhere and paste in	Rules in a Claude Project that apply to every chat inside it	A saved workflow: when to use it, what to ask Backstory, and how to lay out the answer
WHEN IT RUNS	When you remember to paste it	Every chat in that project	On its own when the ask matches. Name a company and a meeting-prep skill fires.
BEST FOR	A one-off question	Ground rules you always want, like time windows	Anything you ask often: call prep, follow-ups, the Monday risk digest

HOW A SKILL RUNS



Build one in *five steps*

- 01** Land on an answer you like
Use the three kinds of questions until the output is the one you'd bring to the meeting.
- 02** Ask Claude to write it up as a skill
When to use it, which questions to ask Backstory, and how to lay out the answer.
- 03** Give every input a default
The full company name, and the last 30 days unless you say otherwise.
- 04** Make gaps show up as gaps
Mark each field sourced, partial or "not available from Backstory" instead of guessing.
- 05** Test before trusting
Three real asks, one of them badly worded on purpose.

SKILL · MEETING PREP

EXAMPLE

Use when

I name a company or say I have a call coming up.

Steps

1. Pull the open deals from the CRM.
2. Ask Backstory for risks, next steps and who's involved.
3. Lead with what to do this week.

Defaults

Full company name. Last 30 days. Confirm the company in the first line.

Gaps

If Backstory returns no data, write "not available from Backstory."

Tested with

"Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight." · "Catch me up on Halden Freight." · one badly worded on purpose

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE · MOCK DATA



Ask the approved prompt. *The skill does the rest.*

THE MOMENT

Tuesday, 8:40am. Call with Halden Freight at 10.

THE ASK

“Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight.”

An approved prompt, nothing extra. The meeting-prep skill recognizes the ask and runs.

HABIT, BUILT IN

The first line confirms the company, so a short name can't pull up the wrong account.

Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight.

Used skill: Meeting prep · Backstory · CRM ›

Halden Freight · Fleet Expansion · \$240K · closes Nov 14

THIS WEEK	Send revised pricing to Dana Ruiz and ask her to bring Marcus Lee to the next meeting.
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RISKS	Pricing concerns raised twice. Marcus Lee (CFO) hasn't joined a meeting in 26 days.
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PEOPLE	Dana Ruiz (VP Operations) is most engaged. Two IT contacts active this month.
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NEXT STEPS	Revised order form. Security questionnaire, no due date set.
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Based on the last 30 days of activity

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE · MOCK DATA



When Backstory doesn't have it, *the skill says so*

Add one rule to a skill: label every field instead of filling gaps. Then a missing detail never looks like a confident answer.

1 You ask

"What's in our account plan for Vantage Retail?"

2 The skill checks each field in Backstory

Goals, stakeholders, budget owner, competitors.

3 Every field gets a label



Sourced

Found in Backstory.



Partial

Some of it was found. The rest is missing.



Not available from Backstory

Backstory has nothing for this field, so the skill leaves it blank instead of guessing.

WHAT YOU GET

Vantage Retail · Account plan

MOCK DATA

Goals

Cut store replenishment time by 20% this year

Sourced

Key stakeholders

Jordan Ellis (VP Supply Chain), Mia Chen (IT Director)

Sourced

Budget owner

Named in the plan, not yet in a meeting

Partial

Competitors

—

Not available from Backstory



Good to know: account plans come back only for customers who keep them in Backstory.

Six skills worth *building first*

ROLE	SKILL	THE QUESTION INSIDE	BUILT-IN CHECK
REP	Meeting prep	<i>"Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight."</i>	Confirms the company first
REP	Follow-up draft	<i>"What next steps did we agree on for the Halden Freight renewal?" Then draft.</i>	Lists owners and dates for you to check before sending
MANAGER	1:1 prep	<i>"What deals does Priya Shah have closing this quarter? Give me the risks and next steps on each."</i>	Treats activity as context, not a rep scorecard
MANAGER	Monday risk digest	<i>"Which of my team's deals closing this quarter have engagement under 50?"</i>	You ask Monday morning and share. Shows how Backstory read the list
VP	QBR themes	<i>"Ask Backstory's assistant what the big themes have been with Halden Freight over the last 90 days."</i>	Labels themes as undated
AM / CSM	Account check-in	<i>"What did we agree to do for Vantage Retail, and who's on the hook?"</i>	Every number gets its time window



Four rules to *set once*

Put these in a Claude Project or at the top of every skill, so no one has to re-explain them.

PROJECT INSTRUCTIONS · EXAMPLE

- 🏠 Use the full company name.
- ⌚ “No data returned” isn’t “no activity.”
- ⌚ Every number gets its time window.
- 🔗 Treat captured activity as context, not a rep scorecard.

EDIT FOR YOUR TEAM

Why the full name

Short names can match the wrong account.

Why “no data” isn’t “no activity”

The activity may not have been captured.

Why time windows

One-account answers cover the last 30 days. Readers should know that.

Why context, not a scorecard

Captured activity isn’t a full record of anyone’s work.

SAME QUESTION, WITH AND WITHOUT THE RULES

WITHOUT

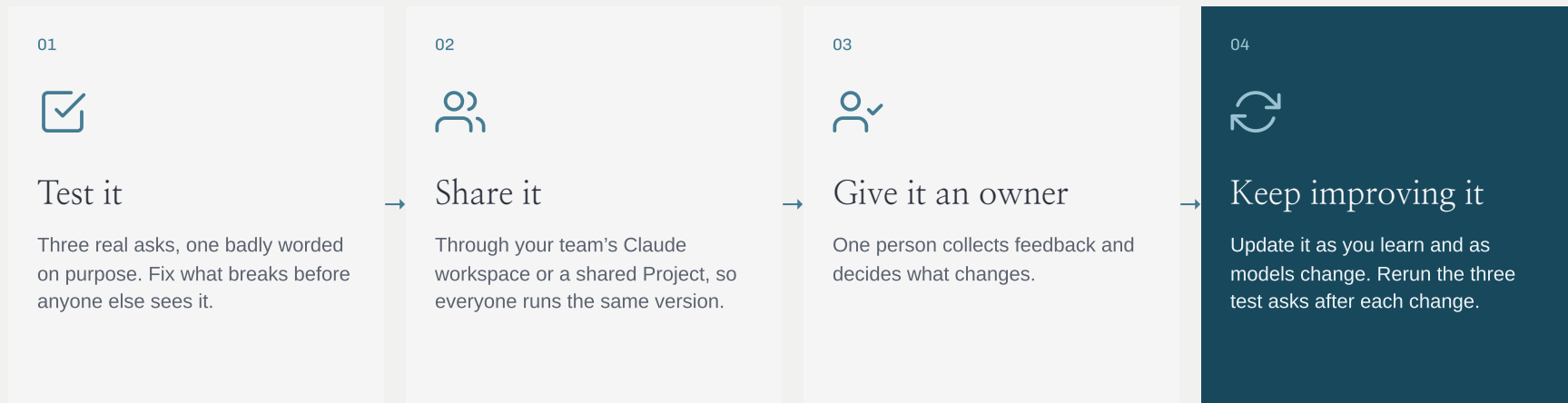
“Vantage Retail had no activity.”

WITH

“No data returned for Vantage Retail in the last 30 days. The activity may not have been captured.”



Share it, and the whole team gets *the same result*



Follow your company's AI policies for what goes into a shared skill. Keep customer data out of the instructions themselves.

TRY ONE THIS WEEK

Save your best answer. *Make it a skill.*

Halden Freight, Vantage Retail, Priya Shah and all people and figures shown are mock examples.